- **Lower Risk of Diabetes:** Pulses are a low-glycemic index food. Including pulses in the diet can make it easier to manage the blood sugar levels.
- **High in Protein:** Pulses also make a healthy and inexpensive source of protein.
- **Good Source of Folate:** Pulses also are a good source of folic acid, a B vitamin needed to produce and maintain new cells.
- **Pulses can help maintain and lose weight:** The fibre in pulses increase the satiety value and helps in reducing and maintaining weight.

Summary

- A cereal is any grass cultivated for the edible components of its grain (botanically, a type of fruit called a caryopsis), composed of the endosperm, germ and bran.
- Cereals are the main source of energy, contributing 70-80 percent of the requirement.
- Cereals contain 6-12 percent protein, which are deficient in lysine.
- Cereals are used in food preparation and processing in a variety of ways. The whole grain can be used in porridge, soups, salads and main dishes.
- Secondary processing of cereals results in a variety of products like bread, flakes, pasta, etc.
- Pulses are the edible seeds of plants in the legume family.
- Pulses give 340 calories per 100 grams which is almost similar to cereal calorie value.
- Soyabean with its high protein contents is considered as a substitute for meat protein which is expensive. Soyabean has 42 grams of protein per 100 grams of the product.

Glossary

Terms	Meaning
ARF	Amylase Rich Food. Amylase Rich Food is germinated cereal flours which are extremely rich in the enzyme alpha amylase. They are excellent weaning foods because they reduce the bulk of the weaning foods and are energy dense.
Bran	It is the hard outer layer of the cereal grain which is rich in fibre.
Dextrinisation	It is the process involving the browning of starch foods when subjected to dry heat. The starch is broken down to dextrins.
Distillation	It is the action of purifying a liquid by a process of heating and cooling.
Gelatinisation	It is the process of breaking down the intermolecular bonds of starch molecules in the presence of water and heat, allowing the hydrogen bonding sites to engage more water.

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